

Tobias Treppmann

Ships production Claude Skills and Projects — and gets teams using them

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've spent fifteen years in product design and more than a decade leading it, and the last year building with the same tools this role rolls out. At Bibel TV I ship production Claude Projects and Claude Skills, and I introduced a support copilot that nobody was required to use. Getting people to actually use a new tool is the part I find interesting, and I have been running workshops for non-designers since Hypoport.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, introduced as an optional tool — a Microsoft Copilot skill I designed and scoped, not a custom build. It drafts viewer letters, emails and social messages in the support handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. The system prompt carries an explicit restricted-topic list, the draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry, and every send decision stays human.
- The rollout was the hard part — I agreed the good-draft target with the support team first, self-tested for a week, then introduced it one person at a time, then let the team lead encourage rather than mandate it. Adoption held across the team, including its most sceptical members. Complex letters take minutes not hours, and temp staff write in the company voice from day one.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysed past letters against their performance, encoded that into a Claude Project that asks clarifying questions before it generates, built the prototype, then shipped a Claude Skill producing follow-up content across in-app notifications, web banners and video scripts.
- Agentic engineering, introduced from zero — Claude Code prototypes running on real APIs, with engineering shipping from that code. Around 70% of AI-generated code lands and iteration went from days to hours. It took trust before engineering would treat prototype code as a real design artefact.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync. Android and Figma are live, iOS and web endpoints defined.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Process mapping, then a scope reframe — mapped a funeral-coordination process that ran on phone calls between parishes, funeral homes and cemeteries. Inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% acceptance, coordinating 20+ cemeteries at the launch customer.
- The rest was designed and initiated, not shipped — shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified. Only booking went live before the M&A centralisation.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries. 1 direct report.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, after my employment there) — a stealth engagement before the product team picked it up. The AI generates a working schema from a description and it renders into the real data-model editor rather than a chat preview, with chat and direct manipulation side by side. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- The design system ran as a structured working group — one design lead and one engineer assigned, a regular meeting rhythm, and an agreed process for spotting component changes and escalating them to the group. Membership and cadence, not goodwill.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — hired two, let two go, and coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Training for people who are not designers — design-thinking training for executive leadership plus service teams including HR, marketing and other non-designer functions. Content and facilitation adapted per audience, executive to operational.
- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the shared service centre. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue, and I worked with IT on the service-desk and ITSM implementation.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Data-dense interfaces — column charts, big-data pivot tables, aggregated JSON views, filter logic. Solved the sample-based uncertainty problem in query-builder previews, where a preview can show nothing while the full data holds plenty.
- Research inside regulated industries — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach people working inside banks and insurers.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

Claude and AI Tooling, in Daily Use

Claude Skills and Claude Projects in production · Claude Code · Claude Co-work · Microsoft Copilot · A self-hosted twelve-agent MCP-configured stack with cron scheduling and local embeddings, as personal daily practice · Prompt architecture with clarifying-question loops · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns

Enablement, Facilitation and Adoption

"Designing with and for AI" workshop series since 2024, run independently with a partner agency · Design-thinking training for executive leadership plus HR, marketing and service teams · One-to-one onboarding onto new AI tooling · A design system run as a structured cross-functional working group with assigned members, meeting rhythm and an escalation process · Long-term mentoring at CareerFoundry and IxDF

Process Mapping and Requirements

Mapped a phone-based coordination process across three stakeholder types and redesigned it as a platform capability · Build-versus-buy analysis · Cross-functional requirements elicitation · Service productisation and catalogue design · Service-desk and ITSM implementation with IT

AI Product Design

Human-in-the-loop by design: restricted topics named in an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt as an output in its own right, the send decision always human · AI under GDPR-plus data-protection law across six countries · Agentic engineering with prototypes on real APIs that engineering ships from · Design system as an API with DTCG tokens and multi-platform sync

Technical Foundation, Self-Taught

HTML · CSS · TypeScript · SwiftUI · Git · GitHub Actions · Style Dictionary · Tokens Studio · Figma · Storybook · Enough to read the code, build the prototype and configure the tooling without waiting for an engineer